

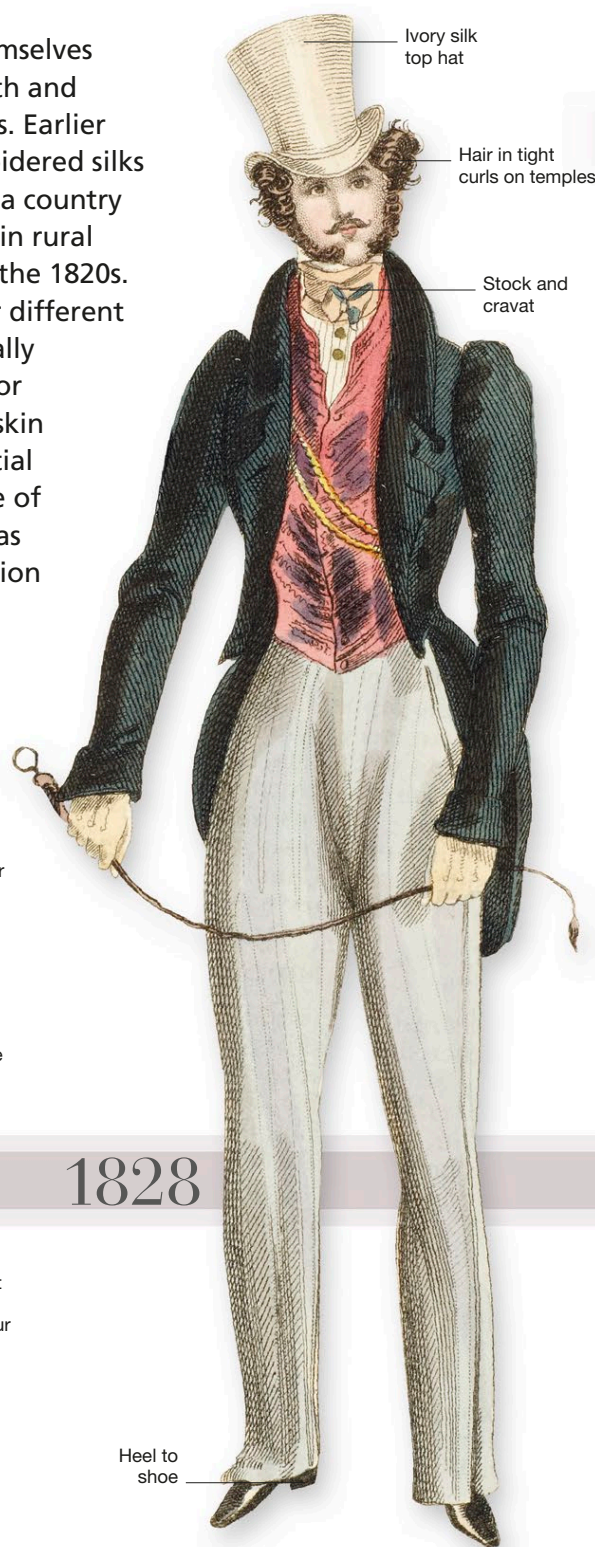
1790–1839

THE RISE OF THE DANDY

Gentlemen in this period prided themselves on the quality of their woollen cloth and the tailoring and fit of their clothes. Earlier interest in elaborate brocaded and embroidered silks disappeared as the upper classes affected a country look. Men's coats were now of fine wool, in rural colours, and developed waist seams from the 1820s. Tailors perfected a range of coat styles for different occasions. Pantaloon and trousers gradually replaced breeches. The riding crop, cane, or umbrella, together with beaver hat, buckskin gloves, and riding boots, were now essential accessories for the man about town. Some of the most exacting Regency dressers, such as Beau Brummell, paid extraordinary attention to every last detail of their appearance. White cotton waistcoats and fine white linen stocks and cravats were a hallmark of their style.



Double-breasted top coat Good-quality woollen cloth tailored to fit, as shown here, looked smart and protected the wearer from severe weather. The top coat was a forerunner of the top frock of the mid-19th century.



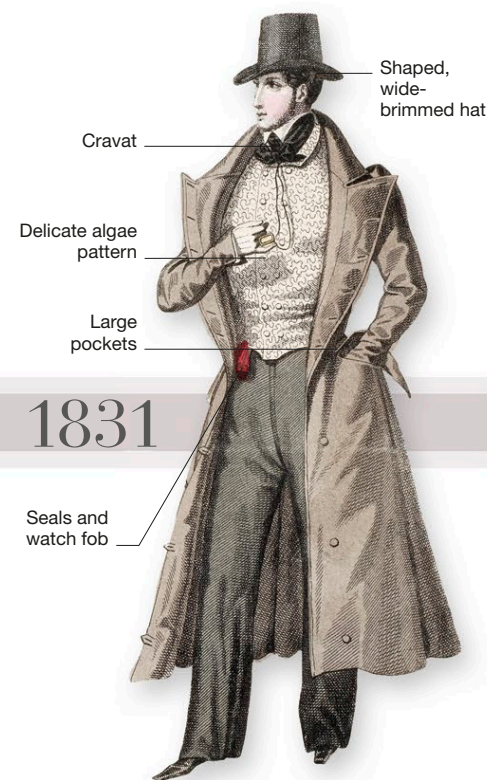
1828

Cossack trousers These pegged trousers show Cossack influence. The single-breasted frock coat has puffed upper sleeves, echoing women's sleeve styles. The ruby velvet waistcoat has a roll collar.



1790

Smart country look This morning walking ensemble to wear in town is influenced by riding apparel. The coat with standing collar has decorative buttons but slopes sharply away to a swallow tail, fastened with hook and eye.



1831

Greatcoat This waistcoat with padded chest has a slightly pointed waistline, echoing women's waistlines. Likewise, the greatcoat has wide lapels that emphasize shoulder width, and full coat skirts that make the waist look small by contrast.